George Kotelawala

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Education

University of Florida — Gainesville, FL
Bachelor of Science in Electrical Engineering; GPA: 4.0 — *Expected Graduation: Spring 2029*

Celebration High School — Celebration, FL
IB Diploma Graduate — *May 2026*

Leadership & Activities

Swamp Launch Rocket Team — Aug. 2026 – Present
Payload Electronics Team Member — *University of Florida*
- Dedicate 15 hours per week to developing PCB-based payload electronics integrating motors, sensors, and microcontrollers for parachute reefing systems on high-power rockets competing in the IREC Multistage 30,000-ft altitude competition using KiCAD

Society of Asian Scientists & Engineers (SASE) — Aug. 2026 – Present
SASE Projects — *University of Florida*
- Collaborate with a small team to design a custom 4-layer PCB flight controller integrating sensors, motors, cameras, and embedded electronics for autonomous search-and-rescue drone applications over the course of 2 semesters using Altium Designer
- Develop embedded hardware systems for flight stabilization, sensor integration, telemetry, and real-time data acquisition while applying PCB design and Altium Designer expertise

Program for Collaborative Research — *University of Florida*
- Conduct comparative research on generative artificial intelligence models, evaluating their capabilities in synthesizing photorealistic imagery that challenges human perception and visual authenticity
- Design a human-subject study to quantitatively assess the distinguishability of AI-generated imagery from authentic photographs, investigating implications for digital trust and preparing to present research findings at an academic research symposium

IEEE — Aug. 2026 – Present
Open Project Space (OPS) — *University of Florida*
- Dedicate 10+ hours per month to hands-on projects and attend 2 technical meetings per month focused on circuits, soldering, microcontrollers, embedded programming, and communication protocols
- Develop hardware-software projects and an engineering capstone through hands-on design and prototyping

Society of Hispanic Professionals in Engineering (SHPE) — Aug. 2026 – Present
Journal Club — *University of Florida*
- Participate in discussions of peer-reviewed research across engineering and STEM fields, evaluating methodologies, findings, and technical implications
- Present and discuss research findings with peers, developing technical communication and critical analysis skills

UF Wrestling Club — Aug. 2026 – Present
Member — *University of Florida*
- Developed strength, endurance, and wrestling techniques through rigorous weekly conditioning and practice

Varsity Wrestling Team — 2023 – 2026
Captain — *Celebration High School*
- Captained varsity wrestling as a senior after 3 years of competition
- Qualified for regionals 2 times and earned 2 OBC placements while maintaining rigorous IB coursework

Youth Wrestling Club — 2025 – 2026
Founder — *Celebration High School*
- Established a 5-week youth wrestling program for local students
- Led weekly practices for an average of 10 participants
- Coached wrestling fundamentals, teamwork, and safe practice techniques

Volunteer Experience

Give Kids the World Village — 124+ Hours
Volunteer — *Kissimmee, FL*
- Assisted approximately 20-50 guests and families per shift through food service, hospitality, and event support, operating recreational activities and amusement rides while maintaining a safe, professional, welcoming environment
- Maintained facility cleanliness and outdoor spaces, collaborating with staff and volunteers to deliver efficient, engaging service in a fast-paced environment

Skills & Honors

Skills: Altium Designer, KiCAD, Breadboarding, Soldering, Microsoft Office Suite, Google Docs & Sheets, Canva, Basic Video Editing, Social Media Management, Strong Teamwork & Communication, Fast Learner and Adaptable

Honors & Awards: Florida Academic Bright Futures Scholarship Recipient, College Board National Recognition Program, AP Scholar with Honor Award, Celebration Foundation Scholarship Recipient, Academic scholarships and grants from UCF, UF, FSU, and USF